Agentic Forecasting Bootcamp

Project Onboarding

VECTOR INSTITUTE | INSTITUT VECTEUR

June 25, 2026

AGENDA

*Note: The presentation deck, recording, and guidelines to be shared after this session.
If you have any questions as we go, please post them in the chat, we will make sure to address them.

1. Project Introduction and Technical Overview
2. Bootcamp Timelines and Structure
3. Project Resources & Data
4. Expectations & Deliverables
5. Certificate and Next Steps

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Project Introduction and Technical Overview

About us and the Bootcamp!



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OUR TEAM



Jessee Ho
Sr. Project Manager
Project Co-Lead



Winnie Au
Project Manager
Project Co-Lead



Ethan Jackson
Technical Team Lead
Applied ML Scientist



Shayaan Mehdi
Associate Technical
Program Manager



Uche Obinwanne
Associate Project
Manager



Chikire Aku-Ibe
Applied AI Intern

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ABOUT THE BOOTCAMP: AGENTIC FORECASTING

This Bootcamp is a hands-on project for those eager to explore forecasting in the Agentic Era. Participants will work on real-world projects to build and backtest forecasting solutions, using **LLMs and agents to combine structured data with rich, unstructured signals** such as news, policy announcements, earnings reports, and environmental context.



Objectives:

- Develop and backtest agentic forecasting solutions
- Compare LLM-based forecasting with statistical and ML baselines
- Gain hands-on experience with forecasting methods that integrate numerical and natural language context

Benefits:

- Learn how **agentic AI systems** can generate and evaluate **forecasts** across real-world use cases.
- Gain **access to reference implementations** (complete GitHub repositories) and **compute resources**.
- Build a **proof of concept** with the **support of Vector's technical team**.

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FORECASTING IN THE AGENTIC ERA

This bootcamp is our next instalment of programming in agentic AI. Forecasting gives us a uniquely rich set of use cases to explore the most advanced techniques in the field:

01

Unstructured signals

Agents can reason over news, policy, earnings reports, and environmental context – not just numbers.

02

Objective ground truth

Predictions are evaluated against what actually happened – a clean, objective feedback signal.

03

Accumulating expertise

Agents can build experience and domain expertise over many forecasting episodes.

04

Unsaturable benchmark

The future is genuinely unknown, one of the last benchmarks frontier AI can (probably) not game.

REFERENCE IMPLEMENTATIONS

From numerical projects to agentic reasoning: a spectrum of methods, illustrated with real-world use cases.

Classical Time Series Forecasting

Predict the next values of a continuous series at a defined horizon. Numerical methods, LLMs, and agents can all be applied. The biggest challenge is sourcing the right dataset.

WHERE IT APPLIES

- Customer demand & inventory planning
- Financial and economic projections
- Weather and operations forecasting

Discrete Event Forecasting

Predict the probability of a future event. Numerical methods work when an observable series exists. Agentic methods take over as questions become more irregular and as context matters more.

EXAMPLE QUESTIONS

- Will the BoC cut, hold, or raise rates at its next meeting?
- Will a Canada-US trade agreement be reached by the end of 2026?
- Will a product launch hit its quarterly target?

Rationale-Aware Forecasting

Go beyond the prediction itself. Use agents to forecast both the outcome and the reasoning behind it in natural language. Calibrate predictions for rationale alignment.

WHERE IT SHINES

- Central Bank decisions (outcomes and rationale)
- Regulatory ruling and official decisions
- Other use cases where expert analysis accompanies forecasts.

REFERENCE USE CASES

Four complete reference use cases are provided. Each includes baselines, data pipelines, and LLM Process + agentic predictor integrations.

01

Economic Forecasting

Canada's Food Price Report Case Study

Real-world annual forecasting exercise. Approximately monthly observations.

Baseline: ARIMA + econometric models. Long-horizon (18-months) consumer price index forecasting.

02

Financial Markets Forecasting

S&P 500

Daily observations (extendable to intraday). Rich signal environment. Notoriously difficult.

Earnings, macro, sentiment, futures — all in one pipeline.

03

Energy Price Forecasting

Crude Oil Prices

Energy markets are highly sensitive to changes in geopolitical context.

Can we build agents to pay attention to the right signals without overfitting to them?

04

Policy Decision Forecasting

Bank of Canada Interest Rate Decisions

Sparse, high-stakes prediction. Extendable into rationale prediction.

Not just "what will they decide" but "why" — connecting prediction to downstream decision pipelines.

EXAMPLE BOOTCAMP PROJECTS

Teams can extend a reference implementation or define a new experiment.

Extend a reference experiment

Improve agent configuration, add new data sources, tune prompting strategies, evaluate against included baselines.

Bring your own problem

Propose a dataset or prediction task relevant to your domain. Subject to feasibility review.

Scenario analysis & rationale

Use prediction agents for interactive what-if analyses, narrative reports, or decision summaries.

Agent memory & learning

Build and evaluate agents with persistent memory across prediction episodes. Watch behavior change with experience.

Agent optimization & search

Compare configurations on the same task — automatically explore the search space of prompting strategies, skill sets, and reasoning patterns.

Reasoning Alignment

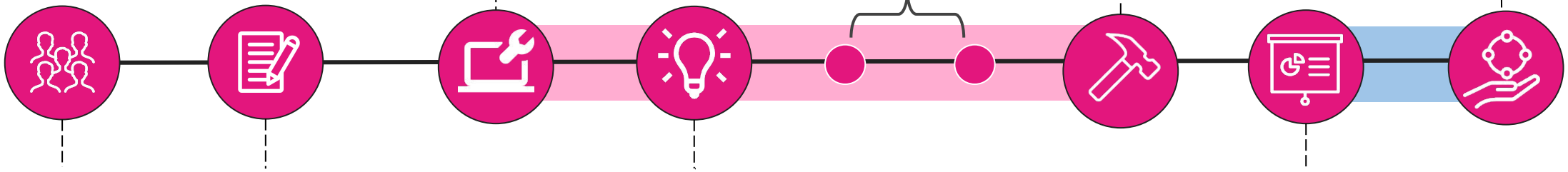
Go further with evaluating and calibrating agentic reasoning. Use expert-written analyses and reports to critique and improve the way agents reason about predictions.

Project Timeline

What are the important dates?



PROJECT TIMELINE (SUMMER 2026)



May 21

Info Session
Call for participation

June 4

Registration Deadline

C1 & C2: June 25

Technical Onboarding
Project kickoff and technical setup

C1: July 8-9 | C2: August 26-27

Learn Days
Lectures and hands-on sessions on state-of-the-art methods

C1: August 4-6 | C2: September 22-24

Build Phase
Participants implement and execute their plans based on their selected use case

C1 & C2: October 22*

Showcase Day
Teams present the work accomplished during the bootcamp

TBD

POC Support Pilot
Post bootcamp POC implementation support pilot

*Tenative

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PARTICIPANT PREREQUISITES

Minimum to Have	• Proficiency in Python programming • Knowledge of Software Engineering • Knowledge of Large Language Models and their limitations
Nice to Have	• Prior knowledge in building agents • Experience with tools like Google ADK, LangChain, LangFuse • Experience with time series forecasting and analysis • Experience building an agent

PARTICIPANT TIME COMMITMENT

Milestone	Description	Cohort 1	Cohort 2	Hours
Technical Onboarding	Technical orientation on Jun 25. Align on project goals and expectations (incl. Technical Q&A)	Jun 25		2
Learn Phase	Learn state-of-the-art methods through lectures and code walkthroughs.	Jul 8–9	Aug 26–27	12
Preparation for Build Phase	Team/data readiness and at least two Vector touchpoints to align on use cases and datasets.	Jul 10–Aug 3	Aug 28–Sep 21	8
Build Phase	A 3-day intensive, hands on session to develop a proof of concept for your use case	Aug 4–6	Sep 22–24	18
Final Deck Preparation and Showcase Day	Preparation and presentation of the work accomplished during the bootcamp	Oct 22		10
		Total		**50**

Note: *Total hours are estimates and may vary by team.*

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AGENTIC FORECASTING - PROJECT GOVERNANCE

Program Leadership

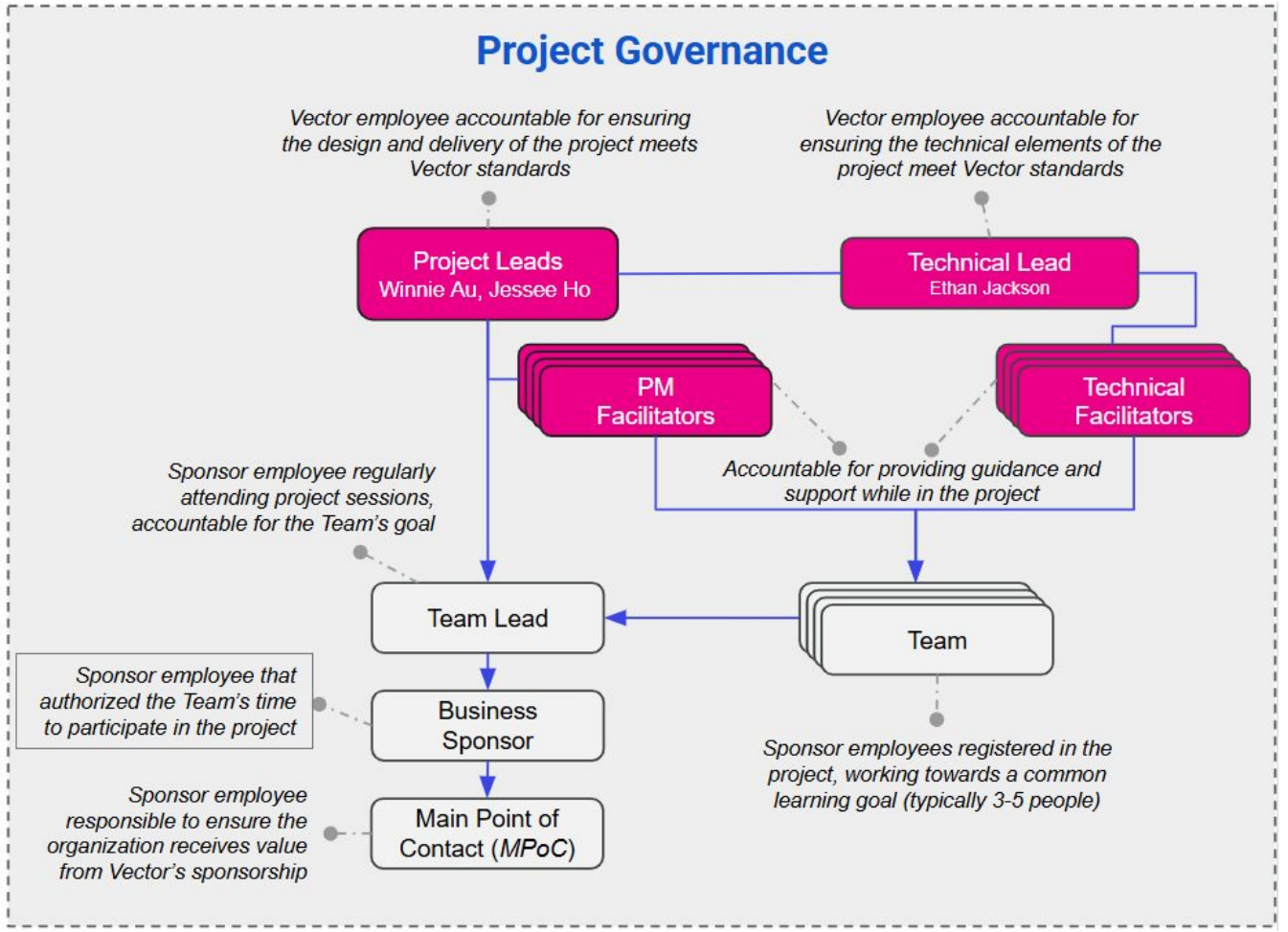
The project leads and Technical leads will ensure overall design, delivery and technical elements of the bootcamp meets vectors technical standards.

Facilitation Team

Each project team will be assigned a dedicated facilitation team comprised of a PM facilitator and Technical advisor.

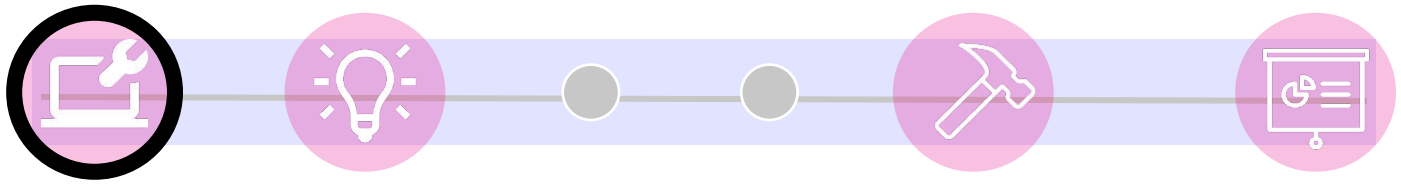
Participant Teams

Each project team has a nominated project lead that will be the point of contact for all communications during the Bootcamp.



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ONBOARDING PROCESS



Onboarding Learn Phase Build Phase Completion

What You Need To Do

- Have submitted **Project Participants Form**
- Have read the technical setup document
- Can access all the resources - Github, LMS, Langfuse and Slack

Onboarding Phase
Jun 25, 2026

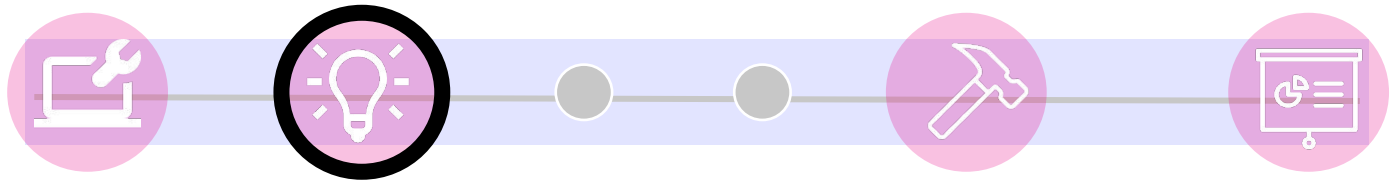
Project & technical overview
+
Q&A

What Should Be Achieved

- Clarity on the expectations of the project
- Understanding of bootcamp environment – Coder, create workspace
- Understand the deliverables and next steps

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LEARN PHASE



Onboarding | **Learn Phase** | Build Phase | Completion

What You Need To Do

- Set up of coder environment and workspace
- Refresh skills if any technical requirements feel challenging
- Reviewed the preparation materials in the LMS (Videos, slide decks)

Learn Days

Cohort 1: Jul 8-9
9:30 am - 3:30 pm ET

Cohort 2: Aug 26-27
9:30 am - 3:30 pm ET

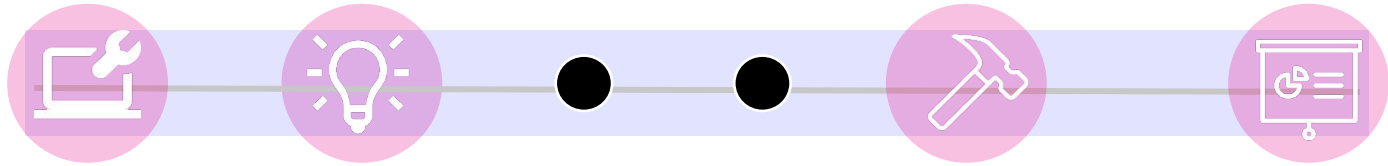
Lectures & Demos
+
Facilitation Sessions
+
End of the day Assignments
(i.e. updating team tracker)

What Should Be Achieved

- Gain practical knowledge of Agentic AI Forecasting methodologies
- Align on the use case to further develop in subsequent phases

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PREPARATION PHASE



Onboarding | Learn Phase | Build Phase | Completion

What You Need To Do

- Gain practical knowledge of Agentic AI Forecasting methodologies
- Align on the use case to further develop in subsequent phases

Preparation Phase
Cohort 1: Jul 10–Aug 3
Cohort 2: Aug 28–Sep 21

Teamwork

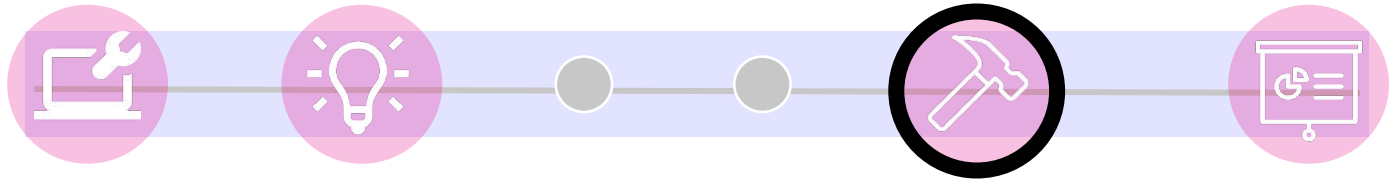
Work on Build Phase Readiness and ensure that a Build Phase Plan (Team Progress Tracker) is in place
+
Two-three, 30 - 45 min touchpoints with Vector facilitators to ensure readiness & help address any questions/concerns

What Should Be Achieved

- Dataset/Tools/APIs confirmed (and approved by Vector) by: **C1:** July 20, **C2:** Sep 8
- Plan for the Build Phase is finished

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BUILD PHASE



Onboarding | Learn Phase | **Build Phase** | Completion

What You Need To Do

- Confirmed dataset (validated by Vector)
- Prepare your dataset based on the use case
- Plan for the Build Phase is finished

Build Phase

Cohort 1: August 4-6
9:30 am - 3:30 pm ET

Cohort 2: September 22-24
9:30 am - 3:30 pm ET

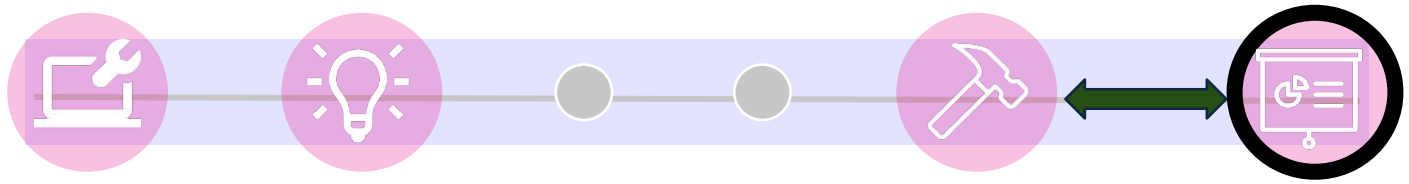
"Hands-on" focus with support from Vector facilitators
+
End of the day presentations (includes ensuring team tracker is updated) to share learnings & insights with other teams

What Should Be Achieved

- Finalized Team Progress Tracker
- Develop an **initial version of the proof-of-concept** addressing the team's use case

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POST BUILD PHASE



Onboarding | Learn Phase | Build Phase | **Completion**

What You Need To Do

Develop an initial version of the proof-of-concept addressing the team's use case

Post-Build phase
Sept 25th - Oct 22

Continue to polish PoC
+
Complete **Final Deck** (starter template found within participant resources)
+
Confirm **Participation** in Showcase Day
+
Complete any other **outstanding assignments** within Team Progress Tracker
+
Certifications

What Should Be Achieved

- Final PoC Version addressing use case
- Final Deck Submitted
- Certificates issued based on criteria

Showcase Day
Oct 22, 2026*

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F2F Implementation Accelerator

Pilot Program | 2-Month Post-Bootcamp Technical Support

2–3 TEAMS

2 MONTHS

~3 HRS / MO / TEAM

PURPOSE

Vector POC Acceleration Follow-Up Program is a targeted post-bootcamp engagement designed to help high-potential sponsor POCs move toward deployment. Recognizing that many POCs stall after bootcamp due to organizational, technical, or capability gaps, the program provides weekly expert-facilitated touchpoints and connections to Vector's technical and platform expertise over two months. By helping teams identify and resolve roadblocks early, the program aims to improve sponsor outcomes, deepen industry partnerships, and helping sponsors realize value from their POCs.

1 Identify

Bootcamp -> Showcase Day

Teams are identified based on **PM/Tech Lead nomination** and/ or **team expressions of interest**.

2 Select

Week 1

- Project & Technical Leads select teams
- Team selection communicated
- Alignment meeting scheduled

3 Align

Week 2

Touchbase to identify support needs and align **AI Eng + SME and Project Team resources**

4 Support

Weeks 3 → Month 2

Weekly 1-hour sessions with AI Eng (primary) + SMEs as needed to help overcome technical issues related to POC progression.

5 Wrap

End of Month 2

Support concludes. Outcomes and challenges are documented

IN SCOPE

What Vector provides

- Expanded technical advisory from AI Engineering (primary)
- SME access as needed: Data Office, Platforms, Governance
- Pre-built frameworks (governance, data policy) for light-lift blockers
- Focus on removing technical roadblocks to progress towards implementation.

OUT OF SCOPE

Owned by the POC team's organization

- Change management and securing executive buy-in
- Alignment with internal sponsor policies and processes
- Driving implementation: teams own the work and momentum
- Navigating internal organizational dynamics

FRAMEWORKS & ACCELERATORS

- Responsible AI Playbook (Principles to Practice)
- Responsible Governance of AI
- Resiliency & Governance Framework
- Maturity Assessment & Use Case Assessment Tools

Project Resources & Data

What platforms and data are we using?



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PROJECT RESOURCES

Technical resources

CODER

langfuse

E2B
Code Interpreter - e2b.ai

Google Cloud Platform

Github

Gemini

Project management resources

zoom

Slack

Google workspace

Vector Institute Knowledge Platform

As a reminder, please use the resources and API keys provided by Vector **only for your participation in this bootcamp**.These resources come from a **shared pool** to ensure **fair access for all participants**.
To maintain a smooth experience for everyone:

- **Do not share** your access or keys with others
- **Use responsibly** and only within the scope of bootcamp activities
- **Misuse will be monitored**, and keys may be revoked if necessary

Thank you for helping us keep things fair, secure, and productive for the entire cohort!

DATASETS AND APIs

- Our coding environment is **designed for learning purposes**, helping teams explore and experiment during the Bootcamp.

- We've **prepared a repository of curated datasets and APIs**, selected based on what is suitable for this bootcamp.
  - **By default, teams are expected to start with these datasets/APIs** for their proof of concept during the Bootcamp.

- If your team prefers to use a different dataset or API, **please discuss this with your facilitators during the Learn Days**.
  - If a request is required, it will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis, subject to validation, capacity, and feasibility.
  - If a dataset or API cannot be hosted in Vector's environment, teams may still work in parallel in their own environment.

Deliverables, Certificates & Expectations

What do I expect?



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KEYS TO A SUCCESSFUL BOOTCAMP EXPERIENCE

Registration [priority]: Fully registered participants will be provided access to our project resources.

Team Submissions: Regularly document project progress to maintain alignment with team objectives and expectations.

Adherence to the Time Commitment: Failure to do so will likely lead to missing the desired outcomes.

Technical Setup: Please complete your technical setup before the Learn Days. The earlier, the better.

- Resolve any access issues early; reach out to Vector if support is needed.
- Use a consistent device and setup throughout the project (e.g., laptop, WiFi, security settings) to prevent technical issues.

Use a device with unrestricted access to all required platforms:
Google ecosystem, cloud compute, Zoom, and Slack.
We will default to the Google Workspace-compatible email you provided during registration.

DELIVERABLES & TEAM PROJECT CERTIFICATE

Project Deliverables:

Learn Day 1 + Learn Day 2 + Build Day 1 + Build Day 2 + Build Day 3 + Final Deck =

Certificates are awarded at **the team level:**

- **Participation certificate:**
  - Complete at least 50% of the project deliverables
- **Completion certificate**:
  - Submit all project deliverables for each project phase (Learn days, Build days, and final deck).

***Team Leads will be asked to nominate participants for the certificate if criterias are met**



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Next Steps

What can you do now?



NEXT STEPS

Access to Resources

For those who have completed participant registration form, you will be receiving access to all Bootcamp resources. If you **haven't received access to any of these resources by the end of next week**, please let us know at agentic-forecasting-bootcamp@vectorinstitute.ai

- **Calendar invites for Learn days (C1: Jul 8-9 | C2: Aug 26-27) and Build Days (C1: Aug 4-6 | C2: Sep 22-24)**
- **Technical Environment Setup (Github, Langfuse):** To complete your technical environment setup, please accept the GitHub invite, log into platform.vectorinstitute.ai and create your workspace.
- **Learning Management System (LMS):** invite from **learn-noreply@vectorinstitute.ai** have been sent out to the first batch of participants. It hosts all session decks, recordings, and supporting documents. MFA may be required upon first login and when returning, typically via a mobile device.
- **Slack Channels:** you will get access to *#agentic-forecasting-c1-general or #agentic-forecasting-c2-general* (general announcements) & *#agentic-forecasting-<your_team_name>* (for team collaboration)
- **Team Workspace/Tracker (Google):** lightweight space to track and reflect on your team's progress

If you are still pending for registration → Access to resources will only be granted once registration is complete.

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NEXT STEPS

Prep for the Learn Days

These steps should be done before the Learn Days (C1: Jul 8-9 | C2: Aug 26-27*) to help avoid any setup issues that could slow down your progress.

- **LMS:** Recording and slides of the Technical Onboarding will be uploaded to the LMS
- **Agentic environment:** Please ensure you complete all the technical onboarding steps reviewed and recorded.
- **Team Tracker:** please provide your technical skills evaluation.

Thank you!

Have questions? Contact us at:
agentic-forecasting-bootcamp@vectorinstitute.ai

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